Races

The four peoples: gifts, feuds, home rosters and what else is keyed to race

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Race is the blood of a realm: it sets which troops the home province raises, the ground most of its provinces lie on, and two gifts no other people share. Two rules apply to every race alike (kinship and the ancient feuds). This sheet puts the four side by side so their gifts can be weighed against each other.

What to look for when reviewing

- Are the two gifts of each race worth about the same? Human and Orcish gifts are about growth and gold; Elven and Dwarven gifts are battle multipliers.
- Does each home roster have a unit of every type (infantry, ranged, cavalry, flyer, naval)?
- Strength per gold of each race's units (see the Army units sheet for the full roster).
- Which race-keyed extras exist: Heritage discoveries (20 each), race-only magic items, guardian weaknesses.

Where this comes from

- Rulebook: The Four Races, Founding Your Realm, Hit points.
- Engine: PROVINCE_ARMIES_P, ARMY_COST_MASTER, KC_UNIT_BASE_STR, SIGNATURE_TERRAIN_P, kinship in terrain-and-unit-strength.js.
- Data file: SAGE_DISCOVERIES_P (Heritage fields), ALL_MAGIC_ITEMS_P (race-gated items), MONSTERS_P (Old Enemy weaknesses).

Rules shared by every race

Rule	What it is
King's kin	A unit of the same race as the king (the realm's chosen race) fights at +20% base strength.
Leader's kin	A unit led by a character of its own race (king or hero) fights at +20%. Stacks with King's kin: a king leading his own people fields them at ×1.44.
Recruits take the province's race	A unit's race is the race of the province it was raised in, not the realm's. Foreign recruits earn no King's-kin bonus.
Ancient grudges	Elves and Dwarves, Humans and Orcs: an army led by a commander of its rival race fights at −20% (×0.8).
Leading another race	Needs Druid 1 (a commander leads his own race as if he had Druid 1). Each missing level costs that unit 20% strength.
Home province	Recruits every land unit of the realm's race whatever its terrain, two of anything a season; a fleet too if coastal. Starting income 10 gold, treasury 20.
Signature terrain	Each race's provinces are weighted toward one terrain (about two thirds of that terrain's provinces carry its race).
Mithril / Iron constitution / Quick learners	Race gifts that name "a character of a X realm" apply only when the character's race matches the realm's race; a hired hero of another blood gets none of them.

The four races side by side

Race	Home ground	Feud with	Gift 1	Gift 2	Full roster (type, base strength, cost = wage)
Human	Plains	Orcish	Drillmasters: human units rise an experience tier twice as readily, from a commander's drills (Practice Tactical/Naval, garrison self-drill) and from surviving battle.	Quick learners: human characters of a Human realm gain skill levels 50% faster, in every skill and by every means (practice ×1.5, experience ×1.5).	Gilded Lances (cavalry, str 7, 4g), Free Lances (cavalry, str 6, 3g), Noble Griffons (flyer, str 6, 4g), Men-at-Arms (infantry, str 6, 3g), Shieldwall Levies (infantry, str 4, 2g), Human Garrison (infantry, str 2, 1g), Yeoman Longbows (ranged, str 4, 2g), Galleon Fleet (naval, str 5, 3g)
Elven	Forest	Dwarven	Woodland mastery: an Elven realm's own elven troops fight at ×1.5 in forest and jungle.	Homeward Flight: an elven unit of an Elven realm that would be killed in battle may slip away home instead: 30% in desert or mountain, 45% on plains, 60% in forest or jungle. Delivered to the home province (or wealthiest remaining) at turn's end, into its garrison.	Stag Riders (cavalry, str 6, 3g), Eagle Riders (flyer, str 6, 4g), Forest Wardens (infantry, str 4, 2g), Elven Garrison (infantry, str 2, 1g), Elven Galleys (naval, str 5, 3g), Shadow Archers (ranged, str 7, 4g), Elven Bowmen (ranged, str 5, 3g), Elven Galleys (naval, str 5, 3g)
Dwarven	Mountain	Elven	Bulwark: dwarven armies defending fight at ×1.5, on top of the usual defender's edge (×1.25, ×1.5 at the home capital).	Mithril Armour: every dwarven character of a Dwarven realm bears mithril (granted at start and on hiring a dwarf): melee blows and arrows against them do 2 less damage. Never found in a lair, scores nothing, cannot change hands.	Ironhoof Rams (cavalry, str 6, 3g), Gnomish Gyrocopters (flyer, str 5, 3g), Dwarven Guard (infantry, str 6, 3g), Dwarf Garrison (infantry, str 2, 1g), Dwarf Ironclads (naval, str 7, 4g), Mountain Guns (ranged, str 7, 4g), Ironwood Crossbows (ranged, str 4, 2g), Dwarf Ironclads (naval, str 7, 4g)
Orcish	Desert	Human	War-spoils: orcish units that win a battle as part of an attacking force pay only half wages that turn (R-065: a true half, on every attacking win).	Iron constitution: orcish characters of an Orcish realm start at 18 max HP instead of 15, and every band of the HP-gain curve sits 5 points higher (so they keep gaining 1–3 up to 45, 1–2 up to 54).	Warg Riders (cavalry, str 6, 3g), Wyvern Riders (flyer, str 6, 4g), Orc Berserkers (infantry, str 6, 3g), Goblin Horde (infantry, str 3, 2g), Orc Garrison (infantry, str 2, 1g), Orcish Longships (naval, str 5, 3g), Black Arrows (ranged, str 4, 2g), Orcish Longships (naval, str 5, 3g)

Roster shape by race

How many units of each type each race can raise anywhere, and their strength per gold at Average quality (base strength × 2 ÷ cost). Garrisons excluded from the averages.

Race	Units	Infantry	Ranged	Cavalry	Flyer	Naval	Avg base str per gold	Avg cost	Avg land move	Strongest unit (base)
Human	8	3	1	2	1	1	1.85	3.0g	3.0	Gilded Lances (7)
Elven	7	2	2	1	1	1	1.76	3.2g	3.4	Shadow Archers (7)
Dwarven	7	2	2	1	1	1	1.86	3.2g	2.6	Dwarf Ironclads (7)
Orcish	7	3	1	1	1	1	1.78	2.8g	3.2	Orc Berserkers (6)

Which units each terrain offers, by race

An ordinary province offers two of these three times in four, three one time in four, drawn from its race's cell for its terrain. Every province also offers its race's garrison; a coastal one its fleet. The first two non-garrison entries of the home terrain's cell are the king's two starting companies.

Terrain	Human	Elven	Dwarven	Orcish
Plains	Shieldwall Levies, Free Lances, Yeoman Longbows, Gilded Lances, Noble Griffons, Human Garrison, Men-at-Arms	Elven Bowmen, Eagle Riders, Elven Garrison, Stag Riders	Dwarven Guard, Gnomish Gyrocopters, Dwarf Garrison, Ironhoof Rams	Warg Riders, Orc Berserkers, Orc Garrison, Black Arrows
Desert	Shieldwall Levies, Free Lances, Gilded Lances, Noble Griffons, Human Garrison	Elven Bowmen, Eagle Riders, Elven Garrison	Dwarven Guard, Gnomish Gyrocopters, Dwarf Garrison, Ironhoof Rams	Orc Berserkers, Warg Riders, Wyvern Riders, Orc Garrison, Black Arrows

Terrain	Human	Elven	Dwarven	Orcish
Forest	Yeoman Longbows, Shieldwall Levies, Human Garrison	Forest Wardens, Elven Bowmen, Shadow Archers, Eagle Riders, Elven Garrison, Stag Riders	Ironwood Crossbows, Gnomish Gyrocopters, Dwarf Garrison	Warg Riders, Goblin Horde, Wyvern Riders, Orc Garrison, Black Arrows
Jungle	Shieldwall Levies, Yeoman Longbows, Free Lances, Human Garrison, Men-at-Arms	Forest Wardens, Shadow Archers, Eagle Riders, Elven Garrison, Stag Riders	Ironwood Crossbows, Dwarven Guard, Gnomish Gyrocopters, Dwarf Garrison	Goblin Horde, Orc Berserkers, Wyvern Riders, Orc Garrison, Black Arrows
Mountain	Human Garrison, Shieldwall Levies, Noble Griffons, Men-at-Arms	Eagle Riders, Elven Bowmen, Elven Garrison	Dwarven Guard, Ironwood Crossbows, Mountain Guns, Gnomish Gyrocopters, Dwarf Garrison, Ironhoof Rams	Orc Berserkers, Wyvern Riders, Orc Garrison, Black Arrows
Sea	—	Elven Galleys	Dwarf Ironclads	Orcish Longships

Everything else keyed to race

Race	Heritage discoveries (race-only research)	Race-only magic items	Guardians weak to this blood (double damage)
Human	20: Free Companies, Yeoman Musters, Drill Fields, Plainsman's Stride, Schools of the Sword, Guild Charters, Militia Tradition, Wandering Scholars, Toll Roads, Household Knights, Longbow Butts, Admiralty, Griffon Masters, Knightly Orders, Shieldwall Drill, Wool Trade, Free Lance Contracts, Letters of Marque, Burgher Levies, Archery Contests	8: Banner of the Free Companies (trinket), Yeoman's Warbow (weapon), Guildmaster's Seal (ring), Knight-Marshal's Baton / Baton of the Constable (trinket), Chirurgeon's Kit (trinket), Standard of the Marches (trinket), Longbow of the Greenwood Levy (weapon), Signet of the Counting-House (ring)	2 guardians: Gnoll Raider, Medusa
Elven	20: Silverwood Bows, Eagle Aeries, Starlight Paths, Wardens of the Glade, Silent Scouts, Moonlit Sails, Sylvan Glamours, Hidden Trails, Forest Bounty, Homeward Song, Warden Oaths, Whale Songs, Shadowweave Cloaks, Eyrie-Born, Elder Tutors, Evenstar Draughts, Elven Markets, Galley Crews, Evenstar Vigil, Swift Arrows	7: Moonsilver Bow (weapon), Starlight Diadem / Circlet of the Evening Star (helm), Cloak of Leaves (cloak), Wardancer's Anklets (armour), Phial of Elvenmead (trinket), Mantle of the Green Shadow (cloak), Bells of the Swift Dance (armour)	5 guardians: Goblin Skirmisher, Stone Troll, Merrow Raider, Sea Troll, Hill Giant Chieftain
Dwarven	20: Deep Delving, Runeforged Mail, Master Gunners, Ironclad Hulls, Hold-Fast, Stonecunning, Guild Halls, Mithril Craft, Siege Foundries, Forge Secrets, Guard Oaths, Ironwood Groves, Gyro Workshops, Powder Magazines, Deep Roads, Anvil Tithes, Rune-Scribes, Hold Veterans, Tunnel Fighters, Garrison Holds	6: Dwarf-Forged Warhammer (weapon), Deep-Delver's Lantern / Mine-Warden's Lamp (trinket), Runic Ale-Horn / Tankard of the Stone Fathers (trinket), Ironclad Captain's Chain (amulet), Anvil-Brand Shield (shield), Chain of the Iron Fleet (amulet)	7 guardians: Dire Rat, Alley Cutthroat, Marsh Sprite, Sea Hag, Goblin Shaman, Iron Golem Shard, Night Hag
Orcish	20: Blood Frenzy, Wyvern Broods, Plunder Hoards, Warg Packs, Endless Horde, Desert Raiders, War Chants, Thick Hides, Trial by Blood, Battering Rams, Berserker Rage, Longship Raids, Goblin Warrens, Warg Kennels, Troll Tamers, Scarred Veterans, Pit Fights, Oasis Raiders, Blooded Garrisons, Wyvern Eyries	5: Skull-Cleaver (weapon), Warg-Hide Mantle / Cloak of the Black Warg (cloak), Blood-Drum of the Horde / War-Drum of Gorok (trinket), Tusk Fetish / Necklace of Skulls (amulet), Berserker's Draught (trinket)	2 guardians: Bandit Scout, Pirate Captain

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	The gifts are not of one kind. Elven (×1.5 in woods) and Dwarven (×1.5 defending) gifts are battle multipliers that apply often; Human gifts are about learning speed and Orcish about wages and HP. Is that the intended spread, and are they worth the same?
2	Elves and Dwarves get their multiplier only as "an Elven/Dwarven realm's own troops". Hired elves in a Human realm get nothing. The Orcish war-spoils rule reads as applying to orcish units in any realm. Check which reading is wanted for each.
3	Humans have the widest roster (9 land and sea units) and the only race with a unit in every terrain cell for plains; Elves have no desert cavalry and Dwarves have no jungle cavalry. The Elven desert cell is three units, two of them flyers/ranged.

#	Observation
4	Human cavalry (Gilded Lances, base 7 for 4g) is the best horse; Orcish Black Arrows and Dwarven Ironwood Crossbows are the cheapest ranged (base 4 for 2g). See the Army units sheet for strength-per-gold across the whole roster.
5	Corsair Fleet is retired (R-109) but is still present in the cost, speed, terrain and unit-type tables and in the Minor Title "heavy units" list. Harmless but worth tidying so a reference does not resurrect it.
6	Race-only items are not evenly dealt: Dwarven 6, Human 8, Orcish 5, Elven 7. Guardian "Old Enemy" weaknesses: see the table above for how many each race can exploit.
7	The rulebook's "Choosing a race" box says "Human + anything leans on the fastest heroes and troops in the game", but Elven and Orcish light horse and the winged riders move as fast or faster. Reword or decide.